

SUPERSONIC BRAHMOS – STRENGTHENING INDIA'S DEFENCE POSTURE AND TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY

As India is celebrating 75 years of independence in the name of 'Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav', the country is emerging as a leading global power due to its rapidly expanding economy and modern military capabilities. Indian R&D establishments have made major strides in the defence technology sector by galvanising its domestic defence industry and have significantly designed and developed state-of-the-art defence systems and cutting-edge military technologies.

Amid the evolving balance of power in the region, the Indian Armed Forces is being equipped with huge conventional and strategic weapons to defend and protect nation's sovereignty and integrity from any internal or external security challenges. State-of-the-art and highly advanced weapon system which has galvanised Indian Armed Force's firepower manifold, the BRAHMOS supersonic cruise missile system, is a perfect emblem of India's growing military might.

BRAHMOS missile has given the Indian Armed Forces the much needed capability & punch to undertake deep surgical strikes in both land and sea, thus protecting its borders and annihilating enemy assets and installations. The potent weapon system has completely revolutionised warfare strategies and tactics in the battlefields.

The supersonic cruise missile has evolved over the years and added many advanced variants – from sea-to-land, sea-to-sea, land-to-land, land-to-sea, sub-sea to land, sub-sea to sea, air-to-sea and air-to-land configurations.

The Indian Army started inducting the land-attack BRAHMOS version from 2007 onwards and has raised several BRAHMOS LACM regiments to date, with each having its own distinct potentiality to hit and

destroy enemy target.

The Indian Navy has deployed the naval version of the BRAHMOS missile on-board its several surface warfare platforms since 2005 as the 'prime strike weapon'. The naval variant of BRAHMOS has been successfully test-fired in both vertical and inclined launch configurations, in solo or salvo mode, from moving warships of the Indian Navy.

The Indian Air Force (IAF) raised the land-attack BRAHMOS squadron in 2014 and in 2020, the IAF commissioned the formidable 'Tigersharks' squadron comprising of Sukhoi-30MKI fighter aircraft armed with lethal BRAHMOS ALCM (Air-Launched Cruise Missile). The Su-30-BRAHMOS combinations have strengthened the IAF with additional lethality for attacking targets protected by powerful air defence assets.

As a true flagbearer of 'Make In India' initiative, BrahMos has empowered the indigenous defence industry of the country. BrahMos Aerospace possesses a full-fledged design centre, a Missile Industrial Consortium, with active participation from both India and Russia, for producing different sub-systems, a world-class integration, and check-out facilities with stringent quality control, which involves over 200 small and medium Indian public and private defence sector enterprises and institutions.

BrahMos achieved another historic milestone on 28 January 2022 when Philippines signed a landmark multi-million dollar defence contract with BrahMos Aerospace for the supply of shore-based anti-ship variant of the BRAHMOS supersonic cruise missile for the armed forces of Philippines. This is the first export order for the missile.

BRAHMOS missile has not only strengthened India's

technological base but also elevated its image in the global arena. BrahMos Aerospace now aims to take it to the next level by designing and developing even more lethal and powerful variants of the existing weapon, including a smaller, smarter BRAHMOS-NG (Next-Gen) for arming a wide range of modern military platforms.

The supersonic cruise missile has successfully established itself as the most potent weapon system and a force multiplier in network centric warfare. As India celebrates 75th anniversary of India's Independence with pride and unity, BrahMos Aerospace wishes the entire Nation a Happy Independence Day.

